Marketing Analytics & Attribution Notes

First-Party Tracking, GA4 Event Modeling, and Blended CAC Measurement

THE GROWTH ARCHIVE | FIELD KNOWLEDGE EDITION 2026

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EXECUTIVE BRIEFING & METHODOLOGY

This digital resource synthesizes production experiments, campaign architecture, and battle-tested systems deployed across high-scale performance marketing campaigns. Every framework included here was verified against measurable CAC, ROAS, and retention.

CORE OBJECTIVES

1. Eliminate guesswork from campaign setup and scale with deterministic rules.
2. Optimize unit economics, attribution models, and conversion rates.
3. Execute standard operating procedures without relying on fragile hacks.

CHAPTER 1: GA4 EVENT ARCHITECTURE & MEASUREMENT

Standardize ecommerce events: view_item, add_to_cart, begin_checkout, purchase.

Pass consistent transaction IDs, currency codes, and coupon metadata in purchase payloads.

Configure custom dimensions for customer type (New vs Returning) and product format.

Set up Server-Side GTM to eliminate ad-blocker tracking loss and ensure privacy compliance.

Reconcile GA4 recorded purchases with database revenue weekly to measure attribution accuracy.

CHAPTER 2: MULTI-TOUCH ATTRIBUTION & MER

Why last-click attribution misleads paid social: acknowledge upper-funnel influence.

Calculate Marketing Efficiency Ratio (MER): Total Revenue / Total Paid Ad Spend.

Track new customer blended CAC to evaluate overall brand acquisition trajectory.

Set up cohort retention retention tables to evaluate cohort profitability over 3, 6, and 12 months.

Build automated alerting for sudden attribution drops or broken checkout tags.

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